

Mathieu Bourret Soto

PhD Candidate in Economics

Applied Microeconometrics | Political Economy & Institutions | Conflict & Peacebuilding | Political Attitudes & Behaviour

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EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics, Bordeaux School of Economics, France 2022-present
Political economy, conflict and peacebuilding; applied empirical research on Latin America.
Supervisors: Matthieu Clément (BxSE), Éric Rougier (BxSE)
Visiting fellow: NOVAFRICA (sponsor: Victoire Girard), Portugal

M.Sc. in Development Economics, CERDI, University of Clermont Auvergne, France 2020-2022
Major: sustainable development
Erasmus: University of Göttingen, Germany

B.Sc. in Economics, University of Montpellier, France 2016-2019

JOB MARKET PAPER

“**Civic Expansion and Targeted Violence under Armed Governance: Evidence from Colombia**” (2026).

Abstract. Do grassroots civic institutions protect local leaders from violence, or expose them? Using Colombia’s *Junta de Acción Comunal* (JACs) and a novel 65-year administrative panel, I exploit within-municipality variation in annual JAC registrations in a continuous-treatment difference-in-differences design. On the full panel, civic expansion raises subsequent targeted killings of social leaders: the average causal effect is positive and significant, on the order of one additional killing for every ninety new JACs. This effect is concentrated in conflict municipalities and is neutral or protective where armed groups are absent; it is strongest where armed governance is durable, a descriptive gradient identified under stronger assumptions than the baseline. A second finding bounds the threat: killings do not reduce subsequent JAC registrations at any horizon, so targeting does not suppress the formation of new boards, though registration is an imperfect proxy for whether they keep functioning. A leader is targeted for their role in the network, not as an individual, so collective protection is the relevant policy lever.

PUBLICATIONS

“**This is our Legacy: Youth Exposure to Repression and Trust in Institutions**” (2026). *Journal of Institutional Economics*, forthcoming.

Working Paper version: <https://ssrn.com/abstract=4804803>

“**Understanding Individual Adaptation to Arboviral Diseases Risk: A Systematic Review of Behavioural Determinants of Prevention and Meta-Analysis for non-tropical countries**”, with Elisa Delor and Marlène Guillon. *International Journal of Infectious Diseases*, 108845, 2026.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ijid.2026.108845>

“**Prevalence and factors associated with the adoption of heat-adaptive behaviors among residents of a French southern region**”, with Marlène Guillon. *Journal of Environmental Psychology*, 109(102883), 2026.
<https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jenvp.2025.102883>

“**What drives adaptive behaviours during heatwaves? A systematic review with a meta-analysis**”, with Marlène Guillon. *Climate Policy*, 24(8), 2024.
<https://doi.org/10.1080/14693062.2024.2388225>

ONGOING WORK

Political Economy and Conflict

“**Reunited? Post-conflict attitudes toward former FARC**”, with Thibaut Plassot-Sansans.

“Fear of Crime in Latin America’s secondary cities: a mixed methods approach”, with Matthieu Clément and Thibaut Plassot-Sansans.

“Fear beyond the metropolis: Insecurity imaginaries and perceptions of security policies in Latin America’s secondary cities”, with Matthieu Clément, Sébastien Cuenot, Thibaut Plassot-Sansans and Éric Rougier.

Environmental and Health Economics

“Preferences for arbovirus prevention programmes: a discrete choice experiment among residents of southern France”, with Marlène Guillon.

RECENT WORK EXPERIENCE

Impact Evaluation Consultant, Eval-LAB	2026
Teaching Assistant, University of Bordeaux	
<i>Mathematical Tools & Inferential Statistics</i>	2024
<i>Computer Science</i>	2023
Research Assistant, University of Montpellier	2022

WORKSHOPS AND CONFERENCES

2 nd Junior Workshop on Economics of Latin America, Berlin, Germany	2026
BxSE Doctoral Seminars, Bordeaux, France	2026
Workshop on Ibero-American Development, Göttingen, Germany	2025
EEA 2025, Bordeaux, France	2025
Nova SBE PhD Research Group, Lisbon, Portugal	2025
2 nd WAP Conference, Bordeaux, France	2025
IT18 Winter School, Canazei, Italy	2025
BxSE Doctoral Seminars, Bordeaux, France	2024
WAPLAC Workshop #1, San José, Costa Rica	2024
AFEDEV Doctoral Days, Paris, France	2024
45 th JESF Conference, Bordeaux, France	2023
BxSE Doctoral Seminars, Bordeaux, France	2023

PEER REVIEW EXPERIENCE

Journal of Environmental Psychology, Frontiers in Psychiatry

RESEARCH FUNDING

IdEx “Investments for the Future” fund & Grand Programme de Recherche HOPE, University of Bordeaux / French State	2022-2026
University of Bordeaux Graduate Research Support (UBGRS), Research visit funding (NOVAFRICA, Nova SBE, Lisbon)	2025
CHANGES Doctoral Research Grant, University of Bordeaux, doctoral research support grant	2023

METHODS & SOFTWARE

Methods: applied microeconometrics, quasi-experimental and causal inference, construction of panel and geo-referenced datasets, qualitative interview analysis and mixed methods, survey and discrete choice experiments, systematic review and meta-analysis.

Software: Stata, R; QGIS; $\text{\LaTeX}$.

LANGUAGES

French (Mother tongue), English (Proficient), Spanish (Conversational)

REFERENCES

Olivier Bargain

Full Professor

University of Bordeaux

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Thomas Calvo

Tenured Researcher

IRD / Paris-Dauphine

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Marlène Guillon

Assistant Professor

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